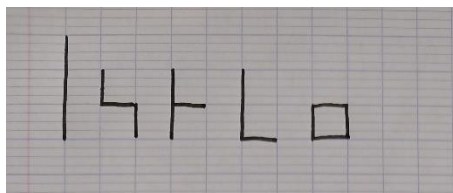


Iso

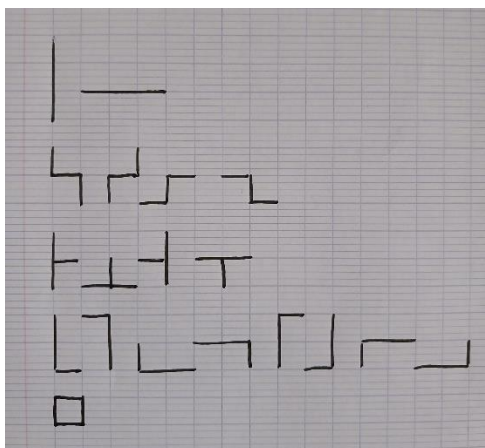
2025, Xavier Bultel, <https://bultel.info/iso.html>

Each player takes a pen. One player draws a 15×15 square grid, called the “play area”. There are five shapes players can draw:



The five possible shapes, named “I”, “S”, “T”, “L”, and “O”

Shapes are considered identical up to rotation and reflection:



On their turn, a player must, if possible, draw a shape by connecting four free intersections in the play area. A free intersection is one that is not already part of a shape, and border intersections are not considered free.

The player must follow these rules:

- First time playing a shape: If the player has never played this shape before they may place it anywhere in the play area
- If it is the first time that this shape is drawn by either player, the player must also draw the shape outside the play area (this records who played it first)
- If the player has already played this shape the new shape must pass through an intersection that is orthogonally adjacent (left, right, above, or below — not diagonal) that must belong to a previously drawn identical shape of the same color

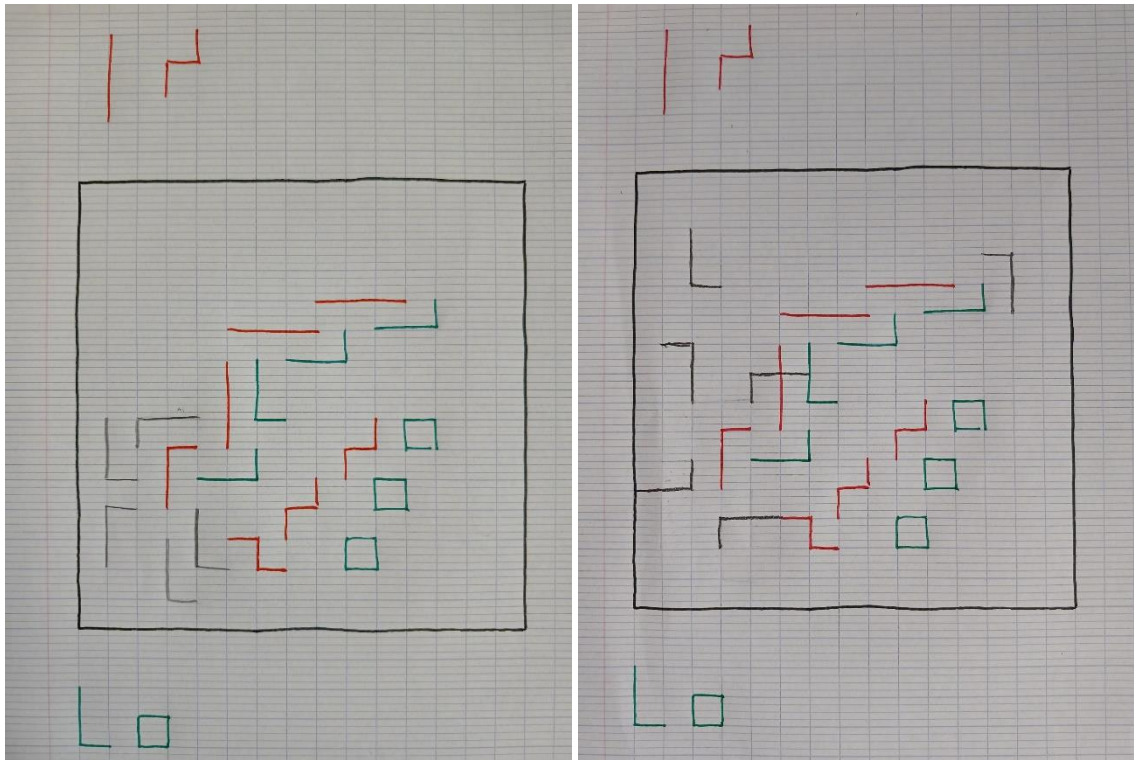
If a player cannot play, they pass their turn.

Goal. The game ends when neither player can draw a shape. If a player has not played all five types of shapes, they lose the game. If both players failed to play all five, the game is a draw.

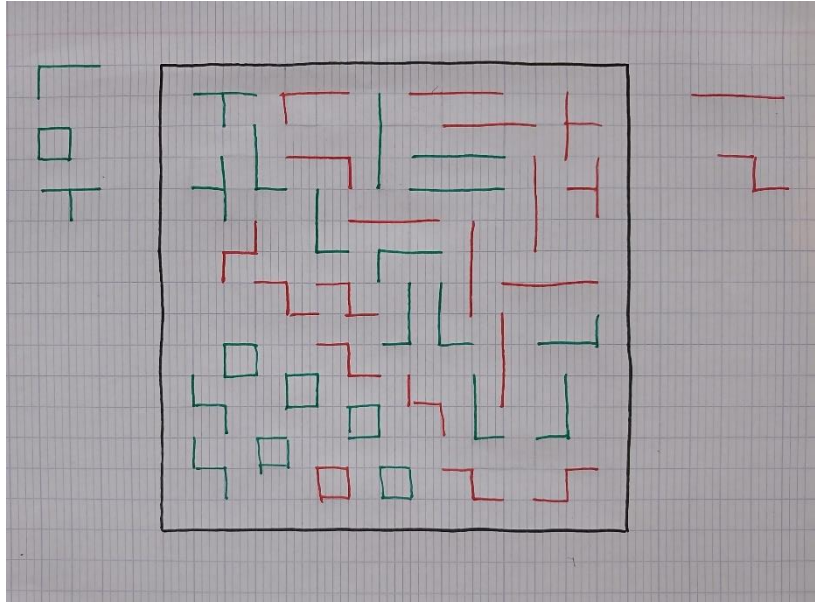
Otherwise, scoring proceeds as follows:

- For each shape, the player who drew it the most times scores 1 point.
- If both players drew the same number, the point goes to the player who did not draw it first (i.e., the one who did not draw it outside the play area)
- The player with the most points wins.

An example:



It is the turn of the red player, who wants to play the “L” shape. In the left image, the grey “L” shapes are legal moves. In the right image, the grey “L” shapes are illegal moves



In this position, no player can add a shape; the game is over.

- The green player has drawn: 3 “I”, 2 “S”, 2 “T”, 8 “L”, and 5 “O”
- The red player has drawn: 5 “I”, 7 “S”, 2 “T”, 2 “L”, and 1 “O”

Scoring:

- Green has more “L” and “O” → 2 points
- Red has more “I” and “S” → 2 points
- “T” is tied

Since the green player was the first to draw a “T” (recorded outside the play area), the point for “T” goes to the red player.

Final score:

- Green: 2 points
- Red: 3 points

The red player wins the game.